

All Areas

2021- 2022

Burning Man's Promoting An Event Report

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(2419CB133A)



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ICB1A/ Haarlem



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0. Introduction

In AAI - Brand Positioning Report we distinguished the 5 core brand values of Burning Man; community-based, creative, spiritual, innovative and radically-inclusive. Through applying both business and psychological analysis models such as PRISM, SWOT and PESTLE (Aguilar, 1967) we discovered that Burning Man is a non-profit org. that aims to hold an annual event with ideologies like “beyond society” and “free community” at its heart. The event tries to shed a big light on inclusivity however due to high ticket pricing the event isn’t being properly represented. Therefore, in 2022, the event will make a comeback with a new positioning which includes new communication strategies. As for AAI – Socially Engaged Event, we **1.** Defined entrepreneurship and identified key components for it to succeed. **2.** Defined CSR and its latest trends. **3.** Set a new purpose for Burning Man for 2022 and decided on a new business partner – Microsoft which can help making the new purpose become a reality for the event and benefit the partner mutually.

0.1 Target Audience: College Graduates – Characteristics

Feature keywords include but not limited to; explorative, adventurous, self-discovery, community builder. (Persona analysis method - Figure 1)

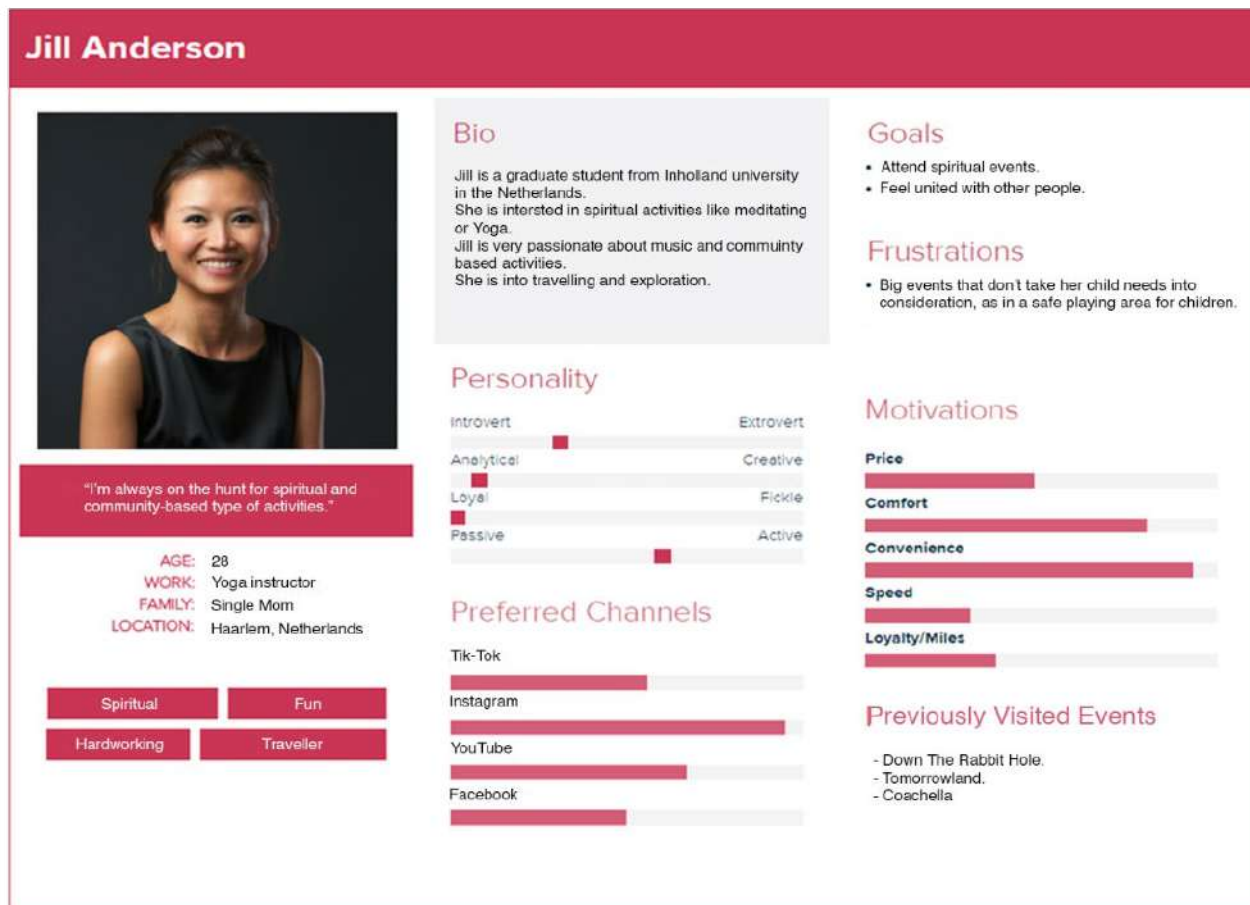


Figure 1

0.2 Previous Promotion Strategy

Who would ever believe that a very popular and quite profitable event is devoid of marketing? In research from Bond (2017) Every person involved with Burning Man swears it's free of it.

Burning Man created a list of 10 principles to get into the heart of its lovers (Figure 2).

Furthermore, the event has created its own language which is called “Moop” by Burning Man’s fans. This helped creating a very strong bind with the audience (Bond, 2017).

The event uses unique and creative posters for promotion every year, usually are illustrations by highly skilled artists.

Figures 3, 4, and 5 show three examples of previous posters of the event in the years 2017, 2018, 2019.



Figure 2



Figure 3



Figure 4



Figure 5

0.3 Corporate Identity Elements

The event tends to use black and white designs as for the logo as well. The use of taglines is important, for 2018 the tagline was “I, robot” as for 2022 the new communication strategy the tagline will be “Think up”. See figure 6 for various corporate identity elements of Burning Man.



1. Creative Brief

The section consists of the creative briefing for the Burning Man event.

1.1 Background

The reason behind creating the renewed poster is to conclude the outcome of the reports; brand positioning, and socially engaged. The new poster is designed on the basis of the new positioning of the brand. In short, the new positioning includes but not limited to; (opportunities, business goals, brand values)

- Highlighting the following brand values; creativity, community-based, radically inclusive, spiritual, and innovative.
- Increase Social Media Exposure.
- Ticket finance aid programs + discounts. (Community Ticket Grants Program)
- Having Microsoft as new business partner.
- Ultimately, gain more attendance, improve brand image, and live up to brand values and the non-profit organization status. (Burning Man Project, 2012)

As for competition, Tomorrowland and Coachella are the two main competitors to the event. (Figure 7)



Figure 7

1.2 Target Audience

According to the data of Burning Man's detailed annual census (2016); college graduates are the main target audience to the event. Figure (2) demonstrates the created persona.

1.3 Objective

Ultimately, gain more attendance, improve brand image, and live up to brand values, and the non-profit organization status.

1.4 Promise

Join us on the ultimate journey to community-building, beyond-society, and endless self-exploration **for everyone**.

1.5 Promise Context

Making emphasis on the following brand values; creative and innovative.

The new purpose for Burning man consist of but not limited to;

- Lowering down the prices, giving discounts for students, teachers...etc.
- Highlighting the creative and innovative brand values
- Creating non-biased financial aid programs to help attendees raise funds to buy their tickets on the event's website or even equipment budget to help set up their camp at the event

With Microsoft joining as business partner, burning man will be able to sponsor 20,000 attendees, make discounts as part of their 2022 branding. (Radically-Inclusive brand value)

1.6 Key Message

The poster should clearly demonstrate the brand's efforts in creating a non-profit event that includes everyone no matter who they were, rich or poor, or what ethnicity or color. It should create a feeling of comfort in the readers mind and bring attention the community-building nature of the event.

1.7 Communication Concepts

A. Emphasis on the following brand values;

- Creative – There are a lot of creative activities taking place at Burning Man
(insert images here)
- Community-based – The event is all about community building, helping each other through dedicated camp sites.
(insert images here)
- Spiritual – A big part of the target audience attends Burning Man seeking spiritual feels.
(insert images here)
- Radically-inclusive – The event mentions the term numerous times on its website therefore that should be present in the communication concept.
(insert images here)
- Innovative/Creative – Lots of innovative people gather and build and be creative at the event. It is highly recommended to show that in the poster.
(insert images here)

1.8 Timing & Parameters

The size of the poster is A3. It will be seen on social media channels such as Tik Tok, Instagram, Facebook, Reddit, Pinterest starting Spring 2022.

2. Generated Ideas

2.1 The creative process for generating ideas started with brainstorming in form of mind maps during dedicated workshop sessions. Keywords, brand values, features associated with the event are laid out to get the creative process started. (Figures 8 and 9)

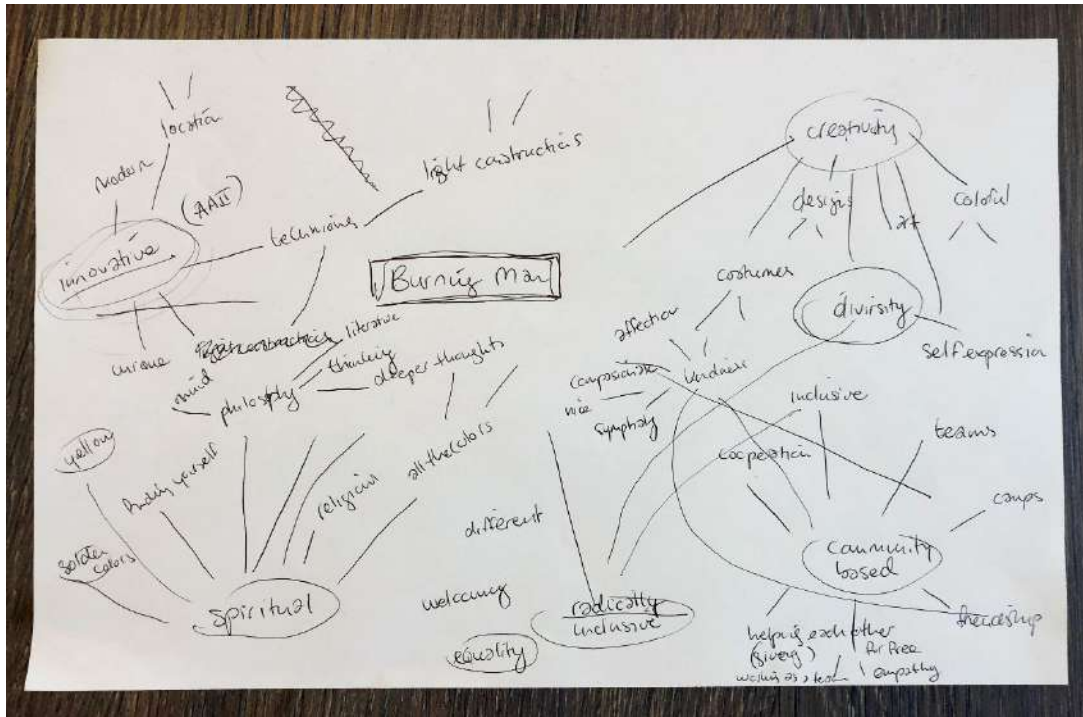


Figure 8

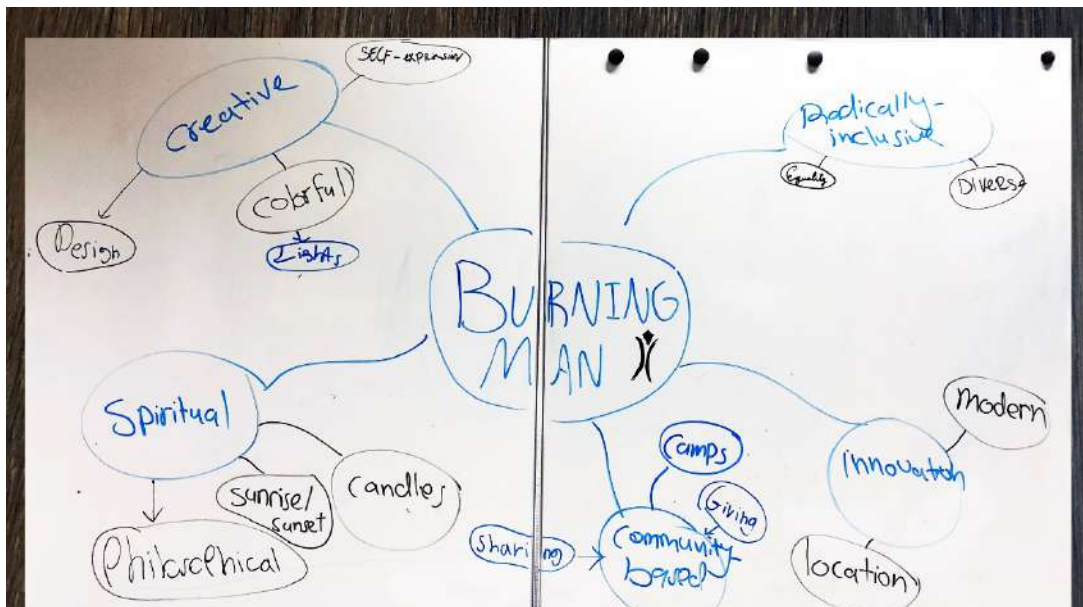


Figure 9

2.2 Brand values breakdown using - the sticky notes method - “Idea-generation activities in design, such as retrieval, association, analogical reminding, synthesis and transformation, are activities that can readily be supported by the affordances of sticky notes” (Ball & Christensen, 2020)

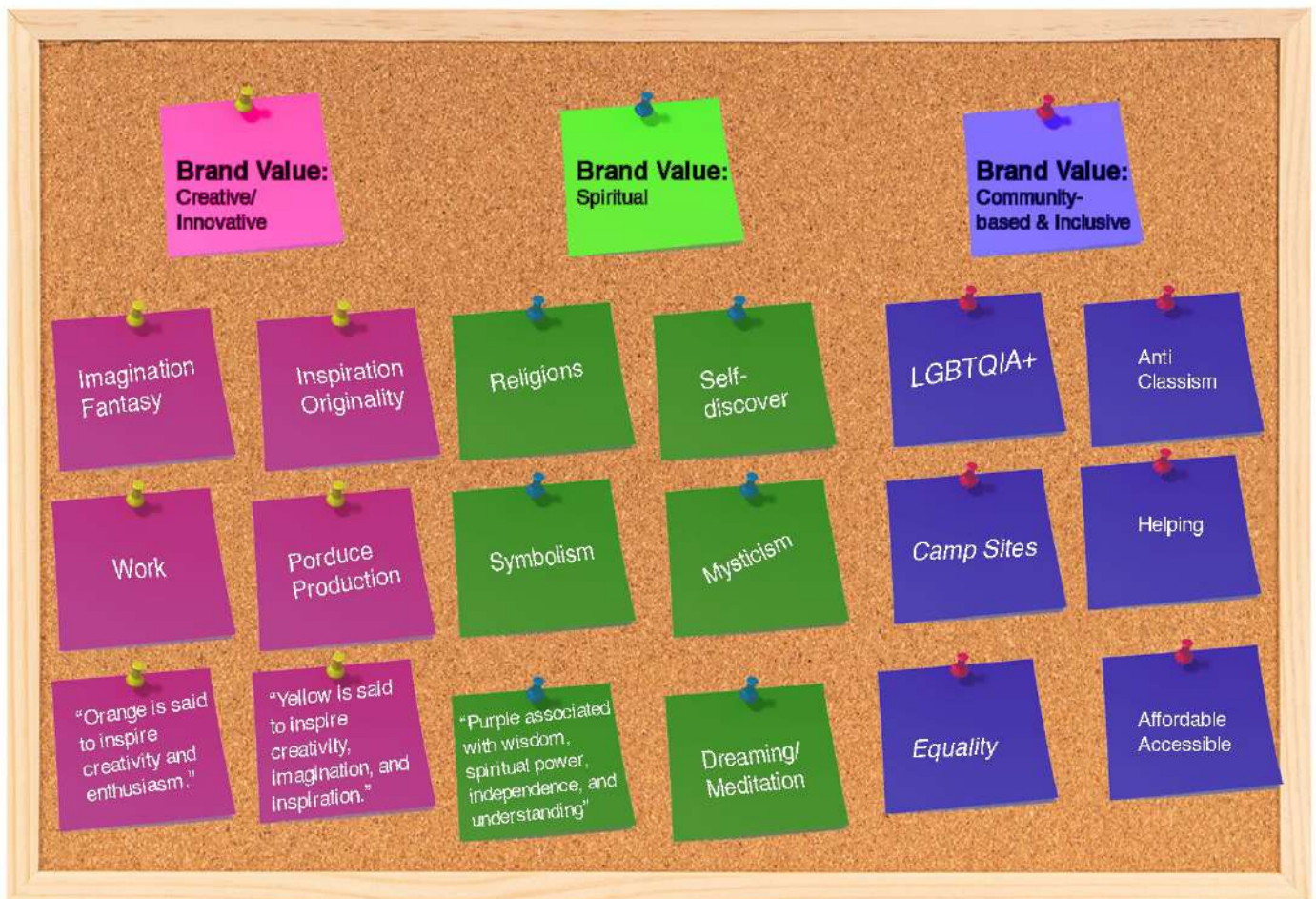


Figure 10

The result of using this technique was expanding on the brand values of the event helped us get inspired for visuals, color palettes, and text used on the poster. Furthermore, it gave clear indications for how the concept boards may look like.

2.3 Objective Analysis

As a wrap up to the creative process, we had to revisit AAI and AAI in order to make so crucial notes reminding us of what the essence of the project is and why is a new positioning required for Burning Man. This was done by noting main concepts and practical yields of the reports as in what they meant and how could they be applied in the poster promotion. (See figure 11)

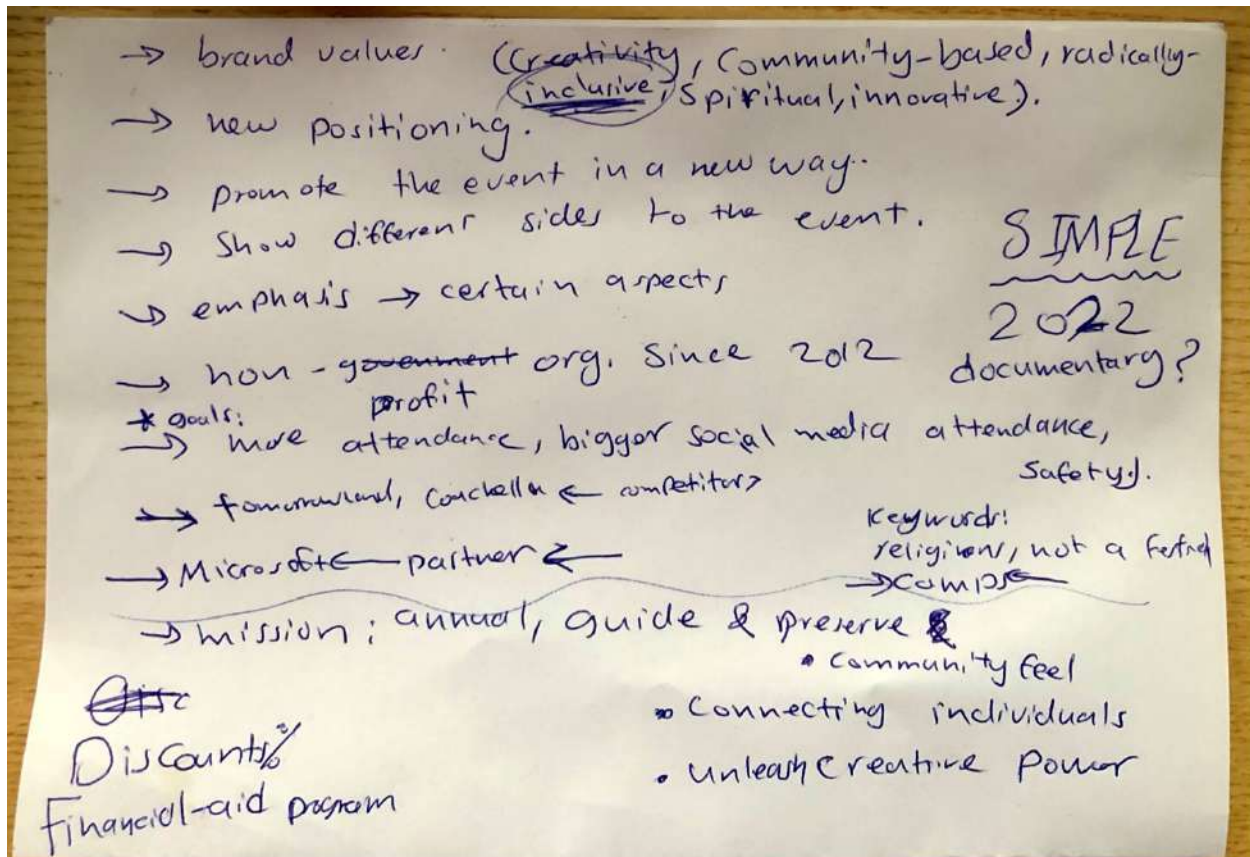


Figure 11

2.4 Mood Board Generation

In research from Zenk (2020) Mood boards drive creativity, improve collaboration process with the client, make sure everything is aligned with promotion objectives, provide efficient and smooth process and last but not least they provide a great reference tool.

The mood board was generated as a result of the previous thinking techniques which ensured the creative process go smooth.

Appropriate colors and visuals have been chosen per brand value in order to get a general feel of how the concept boards should be designed. See Figure 12 for reference.



Figure 12

3. Concept Boards

3.1 The color purple improves creativity by waking our emotions meanwhile promoting essentialism to trigger intuition and insightful remarks (Cherry, 2021) hence, in order to express creativity, shades of purples, blues, reds were chosen for this concept board. Since creativity and innovation are limitless and timeless concepts, I thought the galaxy/space would make appropriate visuals to convey the symbolism. (Figure 13)

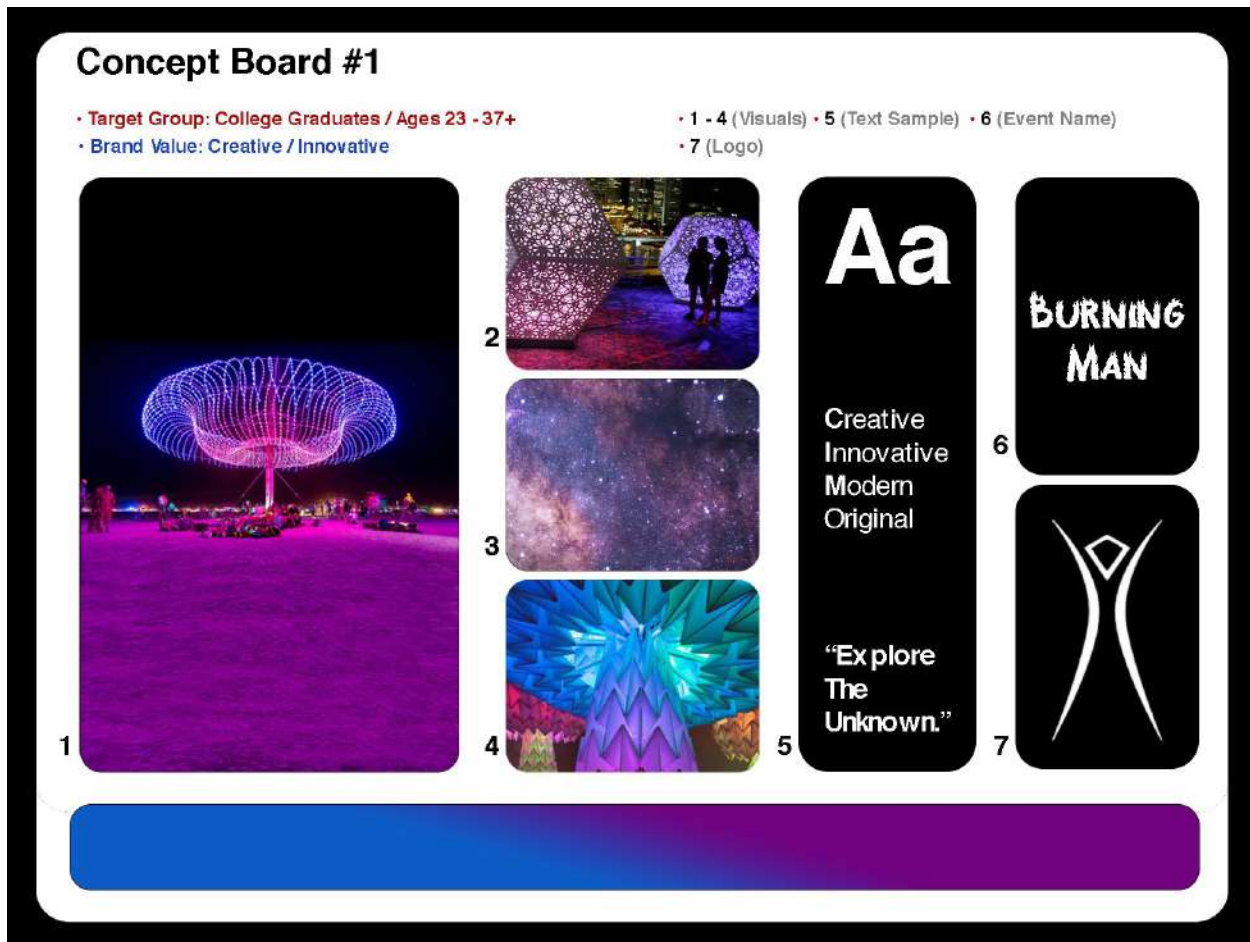


Figure 13

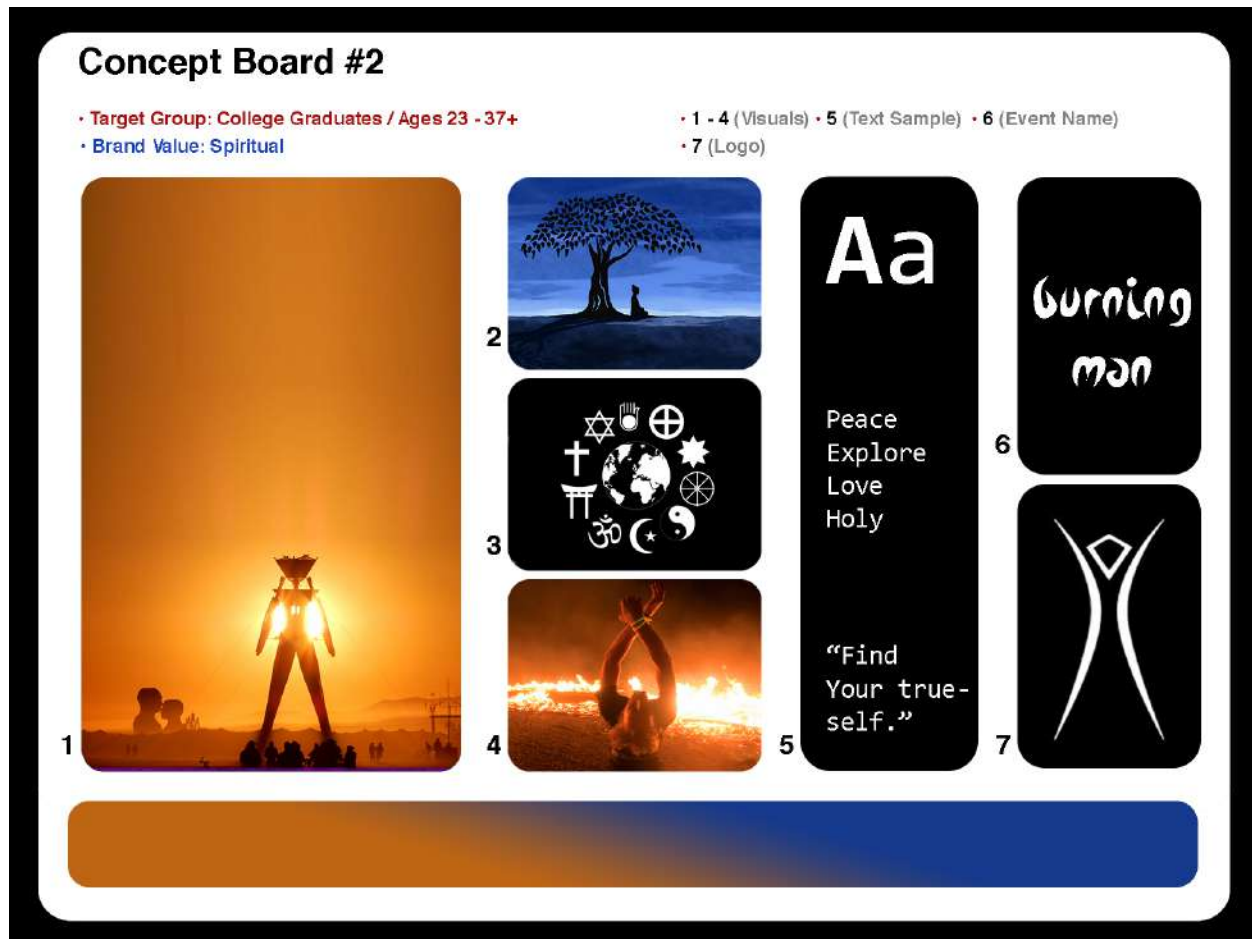


Figure 14

3.2 As for concept board 2, the brand value to be expressed here is spirituality, since a lot of Burning Man goers are self-exploration seekers. The main concept behind the event is based upon spiritualism. What's better than the sun and fire, the blue of water and the sea to express spiritualism. The font chosen is thought to convey and suit the spiritual theme as well. Furthermore, various symbols of religions from around the world were a part of this concept board as it fits the brand value. (Figure 14)

3.3 Earth tones, camp sites at Burning Man, togetherness and inclusivity are what inspired the making of concept board 3 (Figure 15)

Burning Man is pretty much about unity and the concept of a society where people help each other out of charge and without expecting anything in return. This concept board reflects the community-based and inclusive brand values of the event. Visuals 1 to 4 express unity both in a tangible and non-tangible style. Color palate consists of earth tones, sand, and sky.

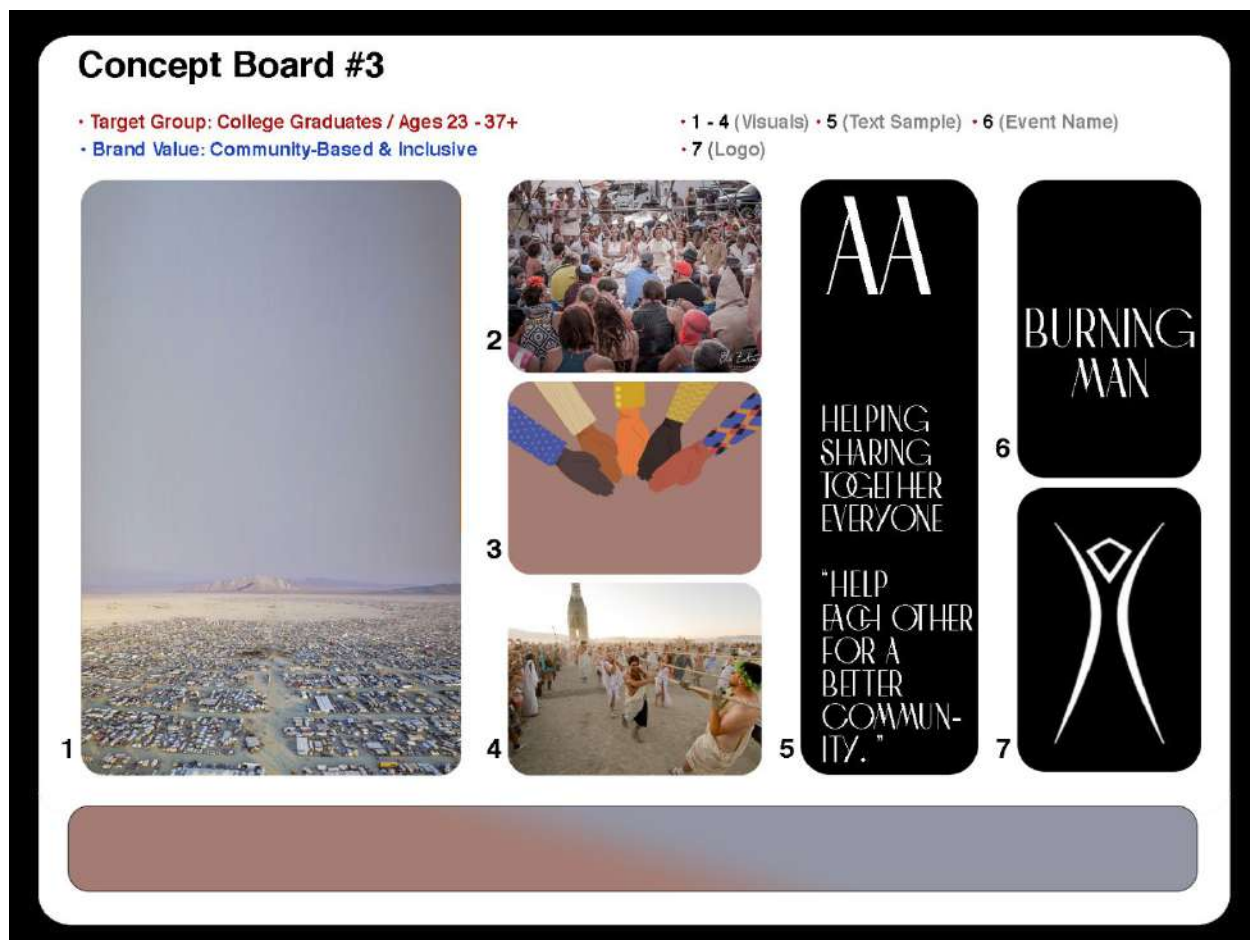


Figure 15

4. Concept Board Pre-Test Analysis

4.1 Practical

In order to get the best insight, a survey was conducted consisting of the three created concept boards in which 10 participants in total took part. The survey questionnaire was created on Google Forms. To see the questions please visit <https://forms.gle/pywFiKgHzYmvB2Lp9>

The majority of the participants were the most interested to visit the concept board 1 event (Figure 16)

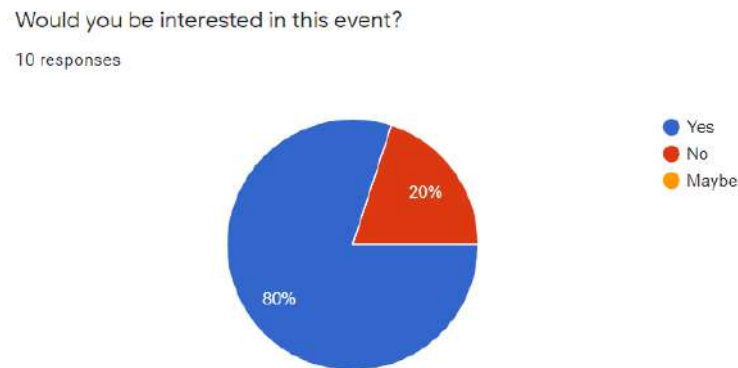


Figure 16

Which as consequence made concept board 1 the chosen concept board of the survey (Figure 17)

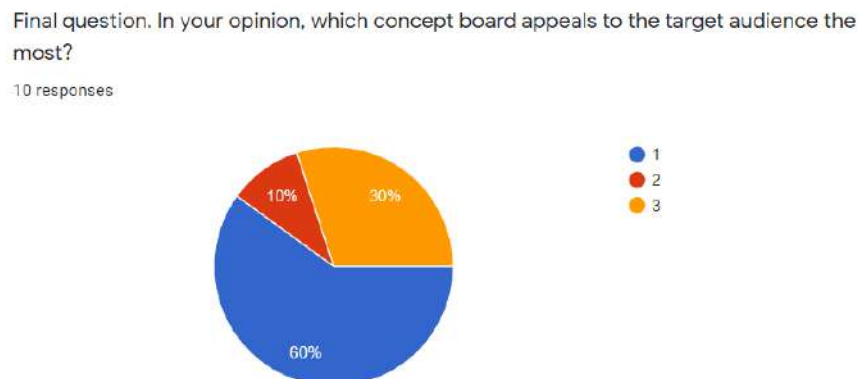


Figure 17

4.2 Analysis

Participants described the winning concept board 1 as innovative and modern. It did a good job at attracting them and enticing their interest to visit the event. The light installation visual was deemed quite the eye catcher.

The colors and overall fonts were also elements that attracted the participants of the survey.

Please refer to Appendix A page 27 for full survey results.

Furthermore, the colorful lights, ornaments, and starry sky appeal to the target audience the most according to the outcome of the questionnaire.

Concept board 1 is based upon the innovative and creative brand values of Burning Man, hence, the new communication concept will be built on that. The 10 participants almost all agree that it is based upon the creative briefing with regards to including everyone Ticket Community Grants program by Microsoft and attracting more audience.

Therefore, concept board 1 was chosen for further development and an indication or base for the three poster concepts. (Figure 18)

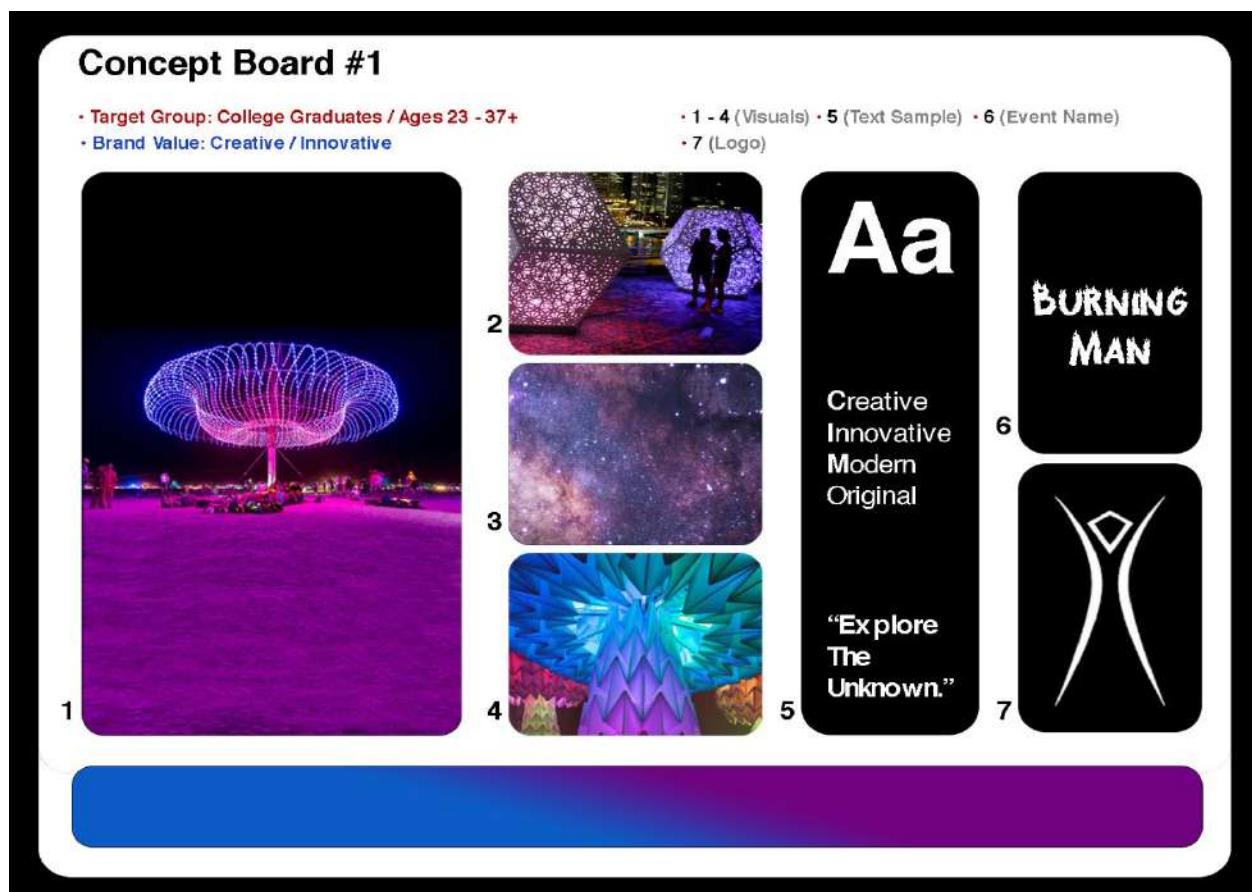


Figure 18

5. Poster Concepts

The poster concepts were based upon the winning concept board from the concept boards survey (Appendix A p.25). The brand values highlighted in the three posters (A3 size) are *innovation* and *creativity*.

5.1 Poster 1 Concept (Figure 19)

The event is held in the Nevada desert. Therefore, I thought it would be cool to include that in the visuals of this poster. The pyramid structure was built previously at Burning Man. It shows the level of innovation and creativity people are capable of at the event. Furthermore, I used Cyan and Red as color contrast as I thought it's a way to catch audience attention when they take a look at the poster. Rules of symmetry and alignment were also taken into account when making this poster.

Utilized visual (Figure 20)



Figure 20



Figure 19

5.2 Poster 2 Concept (Figure 21)

As for this poster concept, vivid colors, among various light elements were utilized as main attracting for this concept. Purple, reds, blues were used as a base color-palette.

The Microsoft logo and the 'Community Ticket Grants' program is expressed. The color font of the name of the event is chosen in white because of the contrast it makes as it stands out from the rest of the visual elements.

Innovation and creativity are also the core communication tools for this poster.

Figure 22 was the main inspiration for this poster.



Figure 22

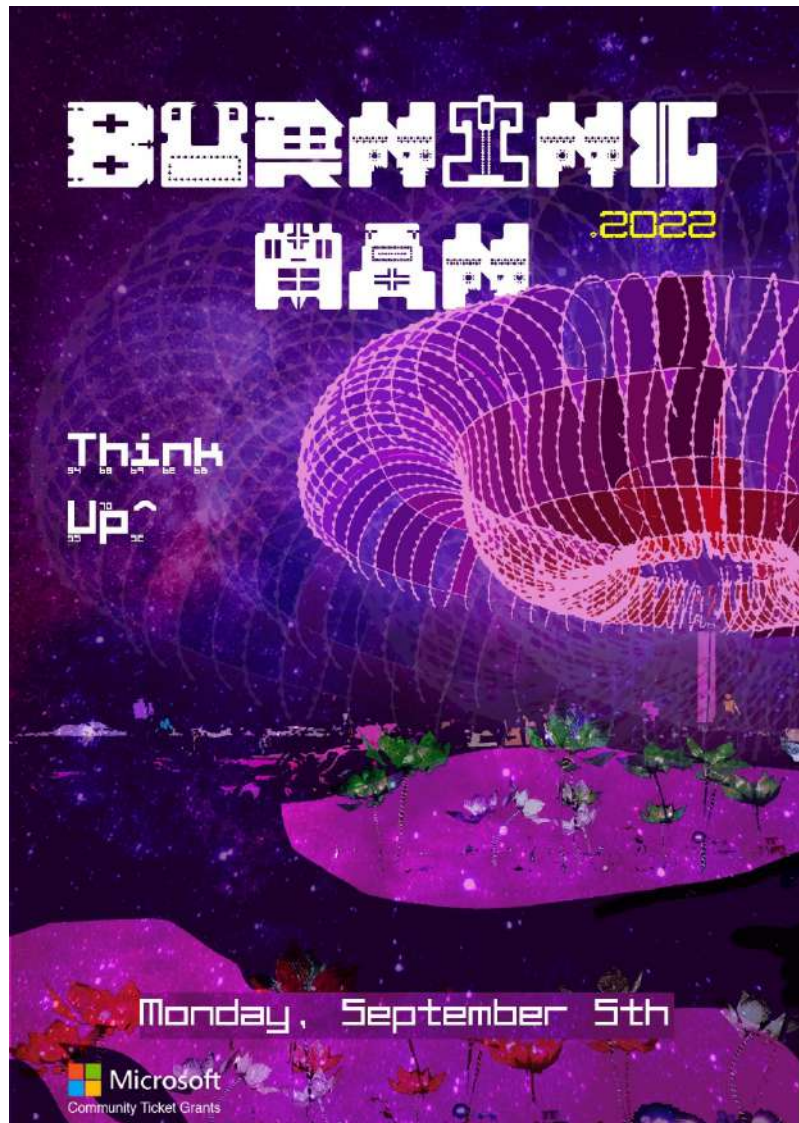


Figure 21

5.3 Poster 3 Concept (Figure 23)

This concept was made to be demonstrating a different side to innovation and creativity. It is meant to differ a little bit from poster 1 and 2 concepts but still carry the same brand values.

The poster was put together from scratch using different visual elements. The main concept behind the poster is combining technological and organic elements to attract audience and remind audience of the creative, innovative brand values of Burning Man.

The name of the event is meant to represent a burning filament of a lamp which is lighting the name of the event to attract attention and suit the name of the event "**Burning Man**".

Visuals utilized (Figures 24 - 25)



Figure 24



Figure 25

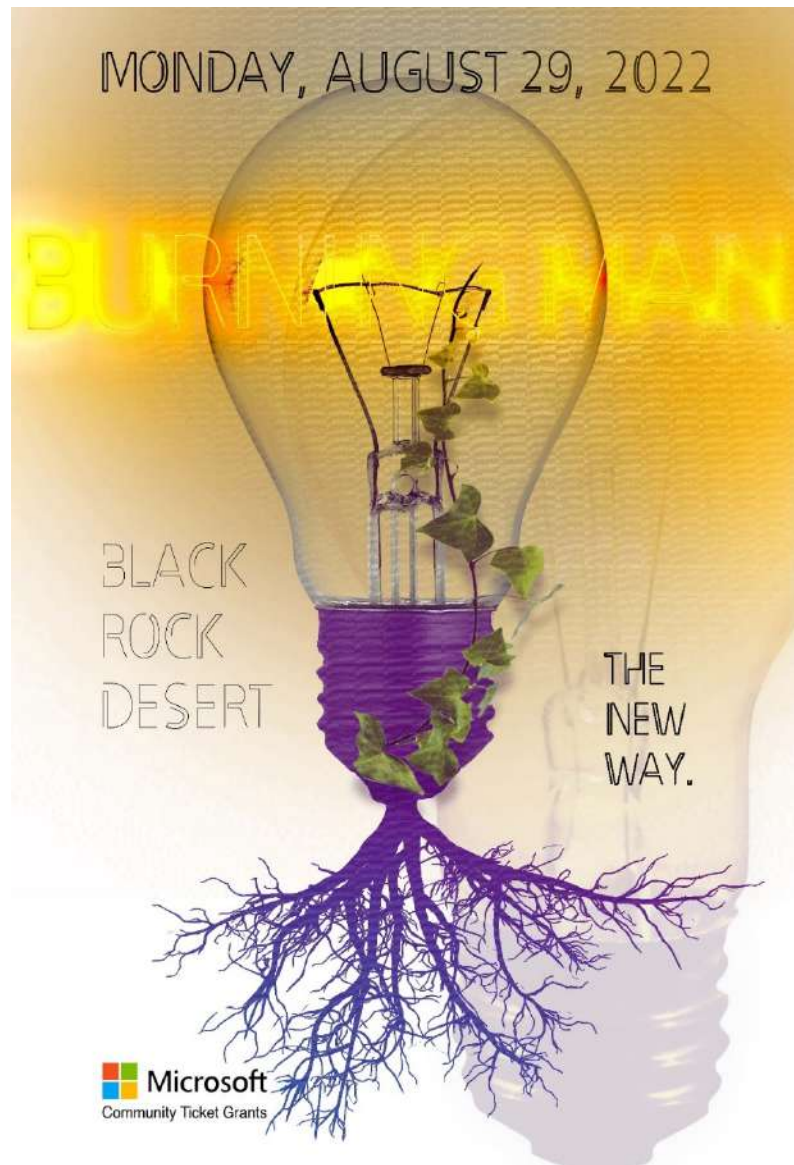


Figure 23

6. Poster Concepts Test Analysis

In order to get the best insight, a survey was conducted consisting of the three created concept posters in which 10 participants in total took part. The survey questionnaire was created on Google Forms. To see the questions please visit <https://forms.gle/xEgMrLFyJZ37CL3s6>

6.1 Practical

The poster concept with the most participating voting is poster 2 concept (Figure 26)

Finally, which poster draft appeals you the most?

10 responses

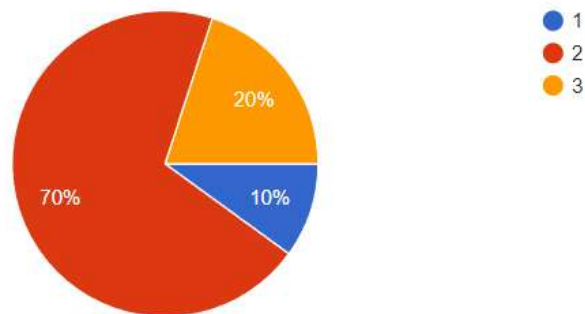


Figure 26

All of the respondents agree that the poster 2 concept applies to the survey description (creative briefing) – Figure 27

After reading the description (located at the beginning of the survey), does poster 2 communicate it sufficiently?

10 responses

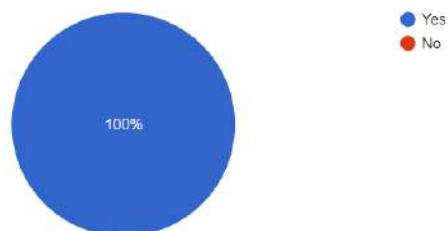


Figure 27

6.2 Analysis

According to survey respondents indicated that poster 2 concept clearly shows the brand values creativity & innovation, and the style fits well with the new partner - Microsoft.

Please refer to Appendix B page 28 for full survey results.

Respondents comments include but not limited to;

"The colors are very eye-catching and attractive and the fonts are very cool! They furtherly attract the audience to observe this poster."

"Contemporary"

"Suits 2022"

"It conveys a nice atmosphere"

"It does show innovation and address the event's partner" ...etc.

Almost all of the questionnaire participants found the shiny and bright elements of the event did a good job at intriguing their interest to visit the event. They felt it suits creativity and innovation. Furthermore, they noted that "Thinking from the target audience's perspective, the second one might be the most attractive and eye-catching. The second poster did a great job on color contrast and stands out from the other posters."

7. The Final Poster

7.1 Final Design (Figure 28) A3-sized.



Figure 28

7.2 Analysis

The final touches on the poster were made according to the poster analysis format survey. Further analogy of the poster was made (Figure 29)

Please refer to Appendix C page 29 for full survey results.

The Black Rock City was added as a name of the location under the event's name. Furthermore, more light elements were incorporate to achieve overall harmony and cohesion. Glowing flowers distributed in the background to add a pop of color. Galaxy, spacey background to suit limitless and timeless innovation and creativity.

Burning Man do not add their logo to their posters usually because the name already speaks to the people enough without a need for a logo. That's why Burning Man spirit was expressed in style rather than logo. Survey respondents (p.29) confirm that the poster suits the soul of the event.

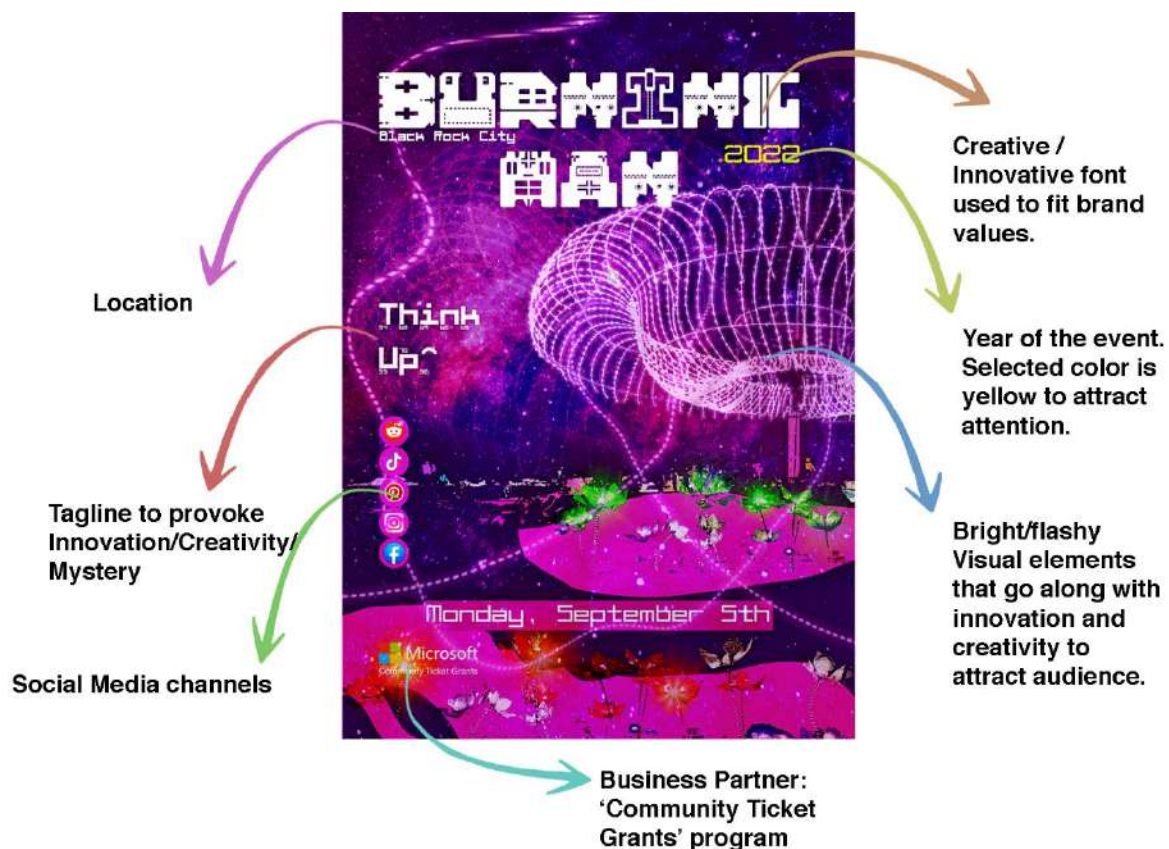


Figure 29

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Retrieved from:

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Appendix A – Concept Boards Questionnaire Results

The survey was conducted using Google Forms with 10 participants in total.

Here's a link to Google Drive for full results (.PDF)

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1YwFCX-K24CgtjOsEFJRlz3p-DoL9U_29/view?usp=sharing

Appendix B - Poster Drafts Questionnaire Results

The survey was conducted using Google Forms with 10 participants in total.

Here's a link to Google Drive for full results (.PDF)

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1QzkoltaQHTqTzNW3UMaUSVjnG8Tyus49/view?usp=sharing>

Appendix C – Poster Analysis Format Results

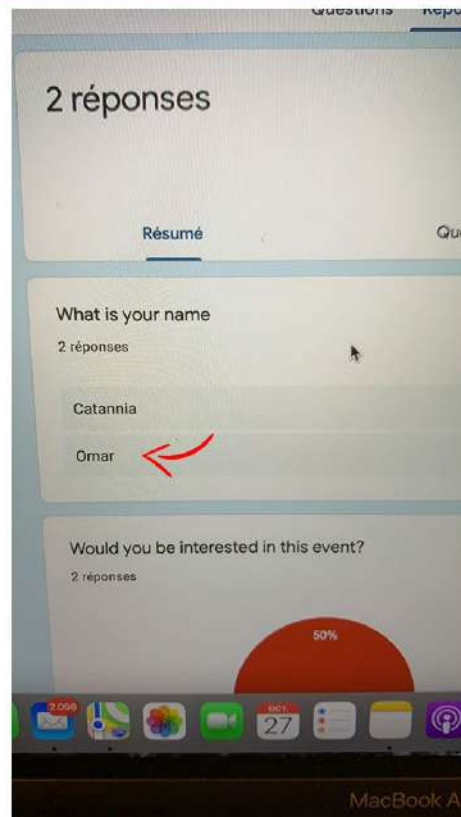
The survey was conducted using Google Forms with 4 participants in total.

Here's a link to Google Drive for full results (.PDF)

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1tBuTjgT_QgW-yE26naPKbMdTek20WPST/view?usp=sharing

Appendix D – Survey Self-Participation

Survey: Poster Concepts - Woohah!
Name of Assesed Student: Romain Faure
Student Number: 683230



Survey: Concept Boards - Burning Man
Name of Assesed Student: Susanna Appelman
Student Number: 689777

Burning Man concept board

Questions Responses 13 Settings

13 responses

Accepting responses

Summary Question Individual

What is your name?

13 responses

Britt Scheveers
Jess
Omar
Wil Appelman
Jeremiah Appelman
Helena Appelman
Daniel Zhang
Joanna Appelman
Anna Xiao

Survey: Poster Concepts - Burning Man
Name of Assesed Student: Susanna Appelman
Student Number: 689777

Burning Man Poster Draft

Questions Responses 10 Settings

10 responses

Accepting responses

Summary Question Individual

Creative Brief

Your name

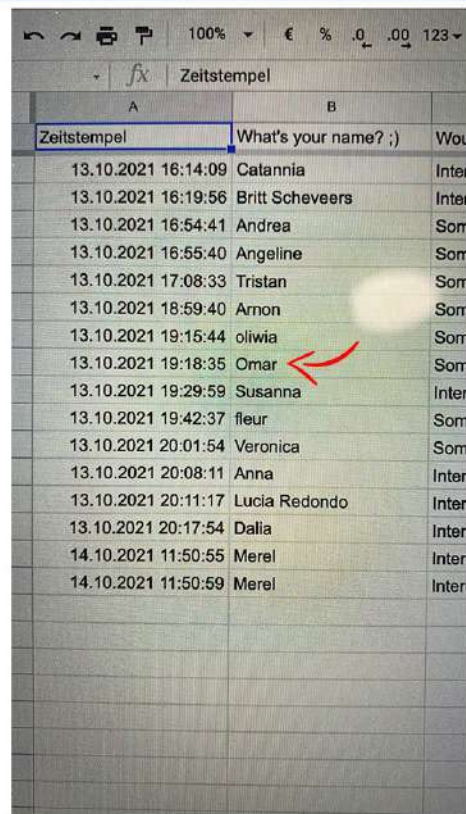
10 responses

Leny
Omar
Wil Appelman
Jeremiah Appelman
Joanna Appelman
Helena Appelman

Survey: Poster Concepts - Pink Pop

Name of Assesed Student: Jessica Redondo Müller

Student Number: 683501



The screenshot shows a spreadsheet with the following data:

	A	B	
	Zeitstempel	What's your name? ;)	Wou
	13.10.2021 16:14:09	Catannia	Inter
	13.10.2021 16:19:56	Britt Scheveers	Inter
	13.10.2021 16:54:41	Andrea	Sorr
	13.10.2021 16:55:40	Angeline	Sorr
	13.10.2021 17:08:33	Tristan	Sorr
	13.10.2021 18:59:40	Arnon	Sorr
	13.10.2021 19:15:44	oliwia	Sorr
	13.10.2021 19:18:35	Omar	Sorr
	13.10.2021 19:29:59	Susanna	Inter
	13.10.2021 19:42:37	fleur	Som
	13.10.2021 20:01:54	Veronica	Som
	13.10.2021 20:08:11	Anna	Inter
	13.10.2021 20:11:17	Lucia Redondo	Inter
	13.10.2021 20:17:54	Dalia	Inter
	14.10.2021 11:50:55	Merel	Inter
	14.10.2021 11:50:59	Merel	Inter

Survey: Poster Concepts - Pink Pop
Name of Assesed Student: Britt Scheveers
Student Number: 677096

Poster Draft Questionnaire

What is your name?

Omar

Cat

Robert

Jess

Merel

Susanna

George B

Survey: Concept Boards - Pink Pop
Name of Assesed Student: Britt Scheveers
Student Number: 677096

Concept Board Questionnaire

Vragen Antwoorden 17 Instellingen

What is your name?

Angelo

Merel

Daphne Oudejans

Kim Kluken

Fem

elin scheveers

Omar

Susanna

Catannia